

HAVEN MAGAZINE

INTERIOR DESIGN

HAVEN

LAUNCH ISSUE • OCTOBER 2026

EMBRACE YOUR SPACE,
INSPIRE THE WORLD.

INSPIRED SPACES

DESIGNS THAT BRING
COMFORT AND
FUNCTIONALITY

TIMELESS ELEGANCE

CURATES SPACES,
MEANINGFUL SPACES.
YOUR WAY

DESIGN FOCUS

IDEAS THAT
ELEVATE EVERYDAY
LIVING

Inspire
YOUR SPACE

EXCLUSIVE
INTERVIEW
Designer
Yumna
on creativity,
balance and
modern living



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ABOUT HAVEN

HAVEN is a contemporary interior design and lifestyle magazine dedicated to inspiring beautiful, functional and thoughtfully designed spaces. From modern interiors and architecture to furniture, renovation and emerging design trends, HAVEN explores ideas that make everyday living more beautiful.

With a focus on clean aesthetics, natural materials and timeless design, HAVEN brings together inspiring spaces, practical ideas and creative perspectives for readers who believe a home should be both beautiful and comfortable.

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Modern Living | Inspired Spaces

Launch Issue • 2026

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Exploring emerging ideas in furniture, materials and Canadian design.



AFFORDABLE SCANDINAVIAN DESIGN FOR EVERYDAY LIVING

Scandinavian design continues to inspire modern interiors through its balance of beauty, simplicity and function. Clean lines, natural materials and soft neutral colours create spaces that feel calm and welcoming. The best part is that achieving this look does not require filling a home with expensive statement pieces. A few thoughtfully selected products can transform an everyday room while remaining practical and timeless.



HAY ABOUT A CHAIR

A modern dining chair with a simple silhouette and curved form. Its understated design works beautifully around a dining table or as an accent chair in a bedroom or living space.



IKEA LACK SIDE TABLE

Minimal, lightweight and practical, this affordable table demonstrates one of the strengths of Scandinavian design: simple objects designed for everyday use.

MUUTO AMBIT LAMP

Soft lighting helps create a warm and comfortable atmosphere. A sculptural lamp also adds visual



interest without introducing unnecessary decoration.

FERM LIVING RIPPLE VASE

Handcrafted-inspired accessories introduce texture and personality. A simple vase can be displayed alone or paired with natural branches and flowers for a softer look.



Good design should be accessible as well as beautiful. By combining functional furniture, warm lighting, natural textures and carefully selected decorative pieces, even a simple room can feel intentional and sophisticated. Rather than following every new trend, choosing versatile objects with clean forms allows a home to evolve naturally over time.

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THE MODERN FAMILY HOME

Beautiful spaces designed for real life.

A beautiful home should do more than look good. It should support the people who live there and adapt to the changing rhythm of everyday life. Today's family home is expected to handle busy mornings, quiet evenings, entertaining, working, studying and relaxing—sometimes all within the same space.

Modern residential design responds to these needs by combining functionality with warmth. Open layouts, natural light, thoughtful storage and flexible furniture allow a home to remain practical without sacrificing personality.

OPEN & CONNECTED

Open-concept living continues to shape contemporary homes because it creates stronger connections between the kitchen, dining and living areas. Instead of separating everyday activities behind walls, shared spaces allow family members to remain connected while doing different things.

However, an open floor plan still needs structure. Furniture can create invisible boundaries between different functions. A sectional sofa can define the living area, while a dining table establishes a separate gathering zone. Rugs, lighting and changes in material can further distinguish these areas while maintaining an open feeling.

SMART STORAGE

Family life comes with belongings, which makes storage one of the most important elements of a functional home.

Built-in cabinetry, deep drawers, concealed shelving and multifunctional furniture can reduce visual clutter without making everyday objects difficult to access.

Entryways especially benefit from thoughtful organization. Closed cabinets can hide shoes and seasonal items, while hooks and drawers keep frequently used belongings close at hand.

The same philosophy applies in the kitchen. Pantry cabinets, deep drawers and concealed appliance areas create cleaner surfaces and make everyday routines easier.

NATURAL LIGHT

Natural light has a powerful effect on how a home feels. Large windows, glass doors and open sightlines allow daylight to travel deeper into a space, making rooms feel larger and more welcoming.

Light-coloured walls and surfaces help reflect daylight, while wood, textiles and warm neutral finishes prevent bright rooms from feeling cold. After sunset, layered lighting can transform the same room. Combining general lighting with lamps, pendants and subtle accent lighting creates flexibility throughout the day.



DESIGNED TO EVOLVE

A successful family home should also be flexible. The way a family uses its space will change over time. A children's play area may eventually become a homework station. A home office might later function as a guest room. Furniture may move and rooms may take on entirely new purposes.

Rather than designing around one moment in time, flexible interiors allow the home to evolve.

Ultimately, modern family design isn't about choosing between beauty and practicality. The strongest interiors combine both.

A home can be sophisticated without feeling untouchable, organized without feeling empty and modern without sacrificing comfort.

MADE FOR REAL LIFE

The most successful family interiors are designed around the people who use them every day. Durable materials, comfortable furniture and flexible spaces allow a home to handle busy routines while still feeling calm and welcoming. When beauty and functionality work together, the result is a home that can adapt, evolve and continue to feel personal for years to come.



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WARMTH MEETS MODERN DESIGN

Kitchens in 2027 are moving toward a warmer, more personal kind of modernism. Clean lines and uncluttered surfaces remain important, but they are being balanced with natural textures, softer colours and thoughtful details. The result is a kitchen that feels sophisticated without losing the comfort that makes it the heart of the home.

01 DARK & DRAMATIC

Deep cabinetry is becoming a confident alternative to the all-white kitchen. Charcoal, black and rich wood tones create depth while maintaining a streamlined contemporary look. Paired with light countertops and warm under-cabinet lighting, darker finishes can feel inviting rather than heavy.

02 WARM MINIMALISM

White kitchens are becoming softer. Warm whites, creamy stone and natural wood accents create spaces that still feel bright and minimal but less clinical. Simple cabinetry and integrated appliances allow materials and subtle variations in tone to become the focus.



03 STATEMENT STONE

Countertops and backsplashes are taking on a larger design role. Quartz and stone-inspired surfaces with expressive veining add movement to otherwise simple kitchens. Waterfall islands and continuous backsplash applications can turn a practical surface into an architectural feature.



04 NATURAL MATERIALS

Natural materials continue to bring warmth and character into contemporary kitchens. Wood cabinetry, stone surfaces and textured finishes soften clean architectural lines and create a stronger connection to nature. Rather than using one material throughout the entire room, designers are mixing finishes to create contrast and depth. A wood island can add warmth to neutral cabinetry, while stone and subtle metal details introduce a more refined finish. These combinations allow modern kitchens to feel layered and personal without becoming visually busy.

05 STORAGE THAT DISAPPEARS

As kitchens become more connected to living and dining spaces, homeowners are looking for ways to reduce visual clutter. Tall pantry cabinets, deep drawers, appliance garages and integrated storage make everyday items easy to access while keeping countertops clear. Small appliances can be concealed behind cabinet doors, while customized drawer systems help organize cookware and utensils. The goal is not simply to create more storage, but to make storage work more intelligently. When everything has a place, the kitchen feels calmer, cleaner and easier to use.

06 THE SOCIAL KITCHEN

The modern kitchen is no longer designed only for cooking. It has become a place for gathering, entertaining, working and spending time together. Large islands are increasingly designed as multifunctional spaces where meals can be prepared while family and guests sit nearby. Comfortable seating and pendant lighting can make the island feel more like furniture than a traditional workspace. This shift is influencing the entire kitchen layout, creating spaces that feel connected to surrounding living areas while still remaining practical for everyday routines.

Ultimately, the kitchen of 2027 balances beauty with everyday function. Warm materials, thoughtful storage, layered lighting and flexible layouts create spaces that feel contemporary without becoming cold. Trends may continue to change, but kitchens designed around comfort, quality and real life have the potential to remain relevant for years.

THE DETAILS THAT MATTER

In 2027, thoughtful functionality is just as important as appearance. Deep drawers, concealed storage, integrated lighting and multifunctional islands help kitchens work harder while keeping visual clutter to a minimum.

“The new kitchen is clean and contemporary, but never cold.”

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IN CONVERSATION

A HOME THAT FEELS LIKE YOU

A conversation with Yumna El Hendi on creating warm, modern spaces that are made for real life.



HAVEN: When you begin designing a home, where do you start?

YUMNA: I always start with the people who are going to live there. A beautiful room is important, but it also has to work for everyday life. I want to understand how the family moves through the space, where they gather and what they want their home to feel like.

HAVEN: How would you describe your design style?

YUMNA: Modern and warm. I love clean lines and simple forms, but I don't want a home to feel cold or overly perfect. Natural wood, soft neutrals, stone and layered textures can bring warmth and personality into a contemporary space.

HAVEN: What makes a home feel luxurious?

YUMNA: For me, luxury isn't about filling a room with expensive things. It's about thoughtful details. Beautiful lighting, good materials, comfortable furniture and finishes that work together can make a simple space feel elevated.

HAVEN: What design mistake do you see most often?

YUMNA: Choosing individual pieces without considering the entire room. You can love a sofa, a table and a light fixture separately, but they still need to communicate with each other. Scale, colour and proportion are just as important as style.

HAVEN: What trends are you most interested in right now?

YUMNA: I'm drawn to warmer interiors. We're seeing softer whites, natural woods, earthy colours and more texture. I also love the movement toward spaces that feel personal rather than designed around one specific trend.

HAVEN: What advice would you give someone designing their own home?

YUMNA: Don't rush every decision. Start with the elements that are difficult to change—flooring, cabinetry and major finishes—and build around them. Most importantly, choose things because you genuinely love living with them, not simply because they're popular.

“*A beautiful home should feel designed, but it should still feel lived in.*”

EVENT REVIEW

INTERIOR DESIGN SHOW TORONTO

Where innovation, craftsmanship and contemporary living come together.

The Interior Design Show Toronto brings together designers, makers, brands and design enthusiasts in a celebration of contemporary interiors. Walking through the show offers an opportunity to experience new furniture, materials, lighting and creative installations while discovering the ideas influencing the future of design.

One of the strongest impressions is the shift toward warmer and more inviting interiors. Natural wood, textured fabrics, stone-inspired surfaces and organic shapes appear throughout the exhibits. Instead of the cold minimalism often associated with modern design, many spaces combine clean lines with materials that add softness, character and comfort.

MATERIAL MATTERS

Natural-looking materials play an important role in creating this warmer aesthetic. Wood, stone, ceramics and tactile textiles bring depth to otherwise minimal spaces. Earthy neutrals are also being paired with deeper accent colours, creating interiors that feel sophisticated without becoming overly formal.

Furniture follows a similar direction. Curved silhouettes, sculptural forms and comfortable proportions demonstrate how contemporary pieces can function as both practical objects and visual statements.

For HAVEN, the Interior Design Show Toronto represents what contemporary design should be: thoughtful, functional, personal and constantly evolving. It offers a glimpse into a future of modern living that is more warm, intentional and beautifully designed.

LIGHTING AS ART

Lighting is no longer treated simply as a necessity. Sculptural fixtures can become focal points, while subtle integrated lighting highlights architectural details and creates atmosphere. The result is a softer, layered approach that can completely change the mood of a room.

CANADIAN DESIGN

The show also provides a platform for Canadian creativity and craftsmanship. Seeing furniture, materials and installations together demonstrates how individual design decisions contribute to the overall experience of a space.

“Design isn’t just about how a space looks, but how it makes you feel.”



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